

# BRAZIL

## Brazil – Key Country Details

| Detail                    | Information                                                                                                                                                             |
|---------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Full Name</b>          | Federative Republic of Brazil                                                                                                                                           |
| <b>Short Form</b>         | Brazil                                                                                                                                                                  |
| <b>Capital</b>            | Brasília                                                                                                                                                                |
| <b>Region (UN)</b>        | Latin America and the Caribbean                                                                                                                                         |
| <b>Government Type</b>    | Federal presidential constitutional republic                                                                                                                            |
| <b>Head of State</b>      | Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva, President                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>Head of Government</b> | Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva, also Head of Government                                                                                                                      |
| <b>Currency</b>           | Brazilian Real (BRL)                                                                                                                                                    |
| <b>UN Member Since</b>    | 24 October 1945 (Founding Member)                                                                                                                                       |
| <b>MUN Standing</b>       | Regional power with active participation in UN peacekeeping, human rights, and environmental diplomacy; major advocate for multilateralism and Global South coalitions. |

## Recommended Books on Brazil's Foreign Policy & UN Role

| Title                                                                                          | Author(s)                        | Why It's Relevant                                                                   |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <i>Brazilian Foreign Policy After the Cold War</i>                                             | Sean W. Burges                   | Covers Brazil's multilateral diplomacy and UN engagement post-Cold War.             |
| <i>The Political Economy of Brazil: Public Policies in an Era of Transition</i>                | Lawrence S. Graham               | Offers insight into Brazil's development policies relevant to ECOSOC and SDGs.      |
| <i>Brazil on the Global Stage: Power, Ideas, and the Liberal International Order</i>           | Oliver Stuenkel & Matthew Taylor | Explores Brazil's evolving foreign policy and global leadership ambitions.          |
| <i>Brazil's International Activism: Soft Power in the Global South</i>                         | Kai Michael Kenkel               | Focuses on Brazil's peacebuilding and development diplomacy within the UN system.   |
| <i>Environmental Politics and Policy in Latin America: Emerging Trends in the Global South</i> | Jeannie Moraes de Oliveira       | Provides critical context for Brazil's role in UN climate and biodiversity agendas. |

## Research Table: Brazil & UNHRC

| Source Name                                         | Link                                                                                                                                                | Why It's Useful                                           |
|-----------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|
| Brazil's Ministry of Human Rights                   | <a href="https://www.gov.br/mdh/pt-br">https://www.gov.br/mdh/pt-br</a>                                                                             | Main HRC-facing ministry managing treaty obligations.     |
| UNHRC Country Page – Brazil                         | <a href="https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/brazil">https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/brazil</a>                                                   | Access to UPR, rapporteur reports, and HRC participation. |
| Brazil's Universal Periodic Review Files            | <a href="https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/br-index">https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/br-index</a>                                       | Full reviews, national reports, and recommendations.      |
| UN Web TV – Brazil at HRC                           | <a href="https://webtv.un.org">https://webtv.un.org</a>                                                                                             | Speeches, debates, and resolutions involving Brazil.      |
| Amnesty International – Brazil Human Rights Reports | <a href="https://www.amnesty.org/en/location/americas/south-america/brazil/">https://www.amnesty.org/en/location/americas/south-america/brazil/</a> | Independent critiques of Brazil's rights conditions.      |
| Human Rights Watch – Brazil Chapter                 | <a href="https://www.hrw.org/world-report/2024/country-chapters/brazil">https://www.hrw.org/world-report/2024/country-chapters/brazil</a>           | Detailed HRC-relevant violations and analyses.            |
| UN Special Rapporteur Reports – Brazil              | <a href="https://www.ohchr.org/en/special-procedures-human-rights-council">https://www.ohchr.org/en/special-procedures-human-rights-council</a>     | Reports on topics like racism, housing, and expression.   |

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|---------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| Inter-American Commission – Brazil                | <a href="https://www.oas.org/en/iachr/">https://www.oas.org/en/iachr/</a> | Regional rulings with UN legal cross-reference.         |
| Justiça Global                                    | <a href="https://www.global.org.br">https://www.global.org.br</a>         | Brazilian NGO contributing shadow reports to HRC.       |
| Conectas Human Rights                             | <a href="https://www.conectas.org/en/">https://www.conectas.org/en/</a>   | NGO with consultative status engaging with HRC.         |
| Instituto Vladimir Herzog                         | <a href="https://vladimirherzog.org">https://vladimirherzog.org</a>       | Advocacy for press freedom and rule of law.             |
| Public Defender's Office – Human Rights Reports   | <a href="https://www.dpu.def.br/">https://www.dpu.def.br/</a>             | State body issuing reports used in HRC monitoring.      |
| Ethos Institute – Corporate Social Responsibility | <a href="https://www.ethos.org.br">https://www.ethos.org.br</a>           | Adds private-sector accountability to rights discourse. |

| Source Name                                 | Link                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | Why It's Useful                                                                                        |
|---------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>OHCHR – Brazil Country Profile</b>       | <a href="https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/brazil">https://www.ohchr.org/en/countries/brazil</a> (ohchr.org)                                                                                                                                                                       | Official overview of treaty obligations; OHCHR working with UNHRC-related activities.                  |
| <b>OHCHR – Brazil UPR Stakeholder Docs</b>  | <a href="https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/uprbr-stakeholders-info-s13">https://www.ohchr.org/en/hr-bodies/upr/uprbr-stakeholders-info-s13</a>                                                                                                                                 | Full set of National UPR, and state submission; crucial for UN cycle evidence.                         |
| <b>OHCHR Press–Business &amp; Defenders</b> | <a href="https://www.ohchr.org/en/press-releases/2024/04/brazil-systemic-impunity-and-economic-interests-are-killing-human-rights">https://www.ohchr.org/en/press-releases/2024/04/brazil-systemic-impunity-and-economic-interests-are-killing-human-rights</a>                     | Highlights timeline to human rights defenders facing commercial interests—tied to HRC business agenda. |
| <b>WebTV – Brazil UPR Adoption 2022</b>     | <a href="https://webtv.un.org/en/asset/k1v/k1v0qfvw4w">https://webtv.un.org/en/asset/k1v/k1v0qfvw4w</a>                                                                                                                                                                             | Video from 41st UPR session—shows Brazil responding to rights recommendations.                         |
| <b>HRW – World Report 2024: Brazil</b>      | <a href="https://www.hrw.org/world-report/2024/country-chapters/brazil">https://www.hrw.org/world-report/2024/country-chapters/brazil</a>                                                                                                                                           | Documents human rights violence, environmental conflicts, and Brazil's HRC record.                     |
| <b>Brazil UPR Adoption 2017</b>             | <a href="https://webtv.un.org/en/asset/k1v/k1vfhn96y0">https://webtv.un.org/en/asset/k1v/k1vfhn96y0</a>                                                                                                                                                                             | Archive from Brazil's third UPR—shows earlier Court assessment.                                        |
| <b>HRW UPR Submission 2012 (PDF)</b>        | <a href="https://www.ohchr.org/sites/default/files/lib-docs/HRBodies/UPR/Documents/session13/BR/HRW_UPR_BRA_S13_2012_HumanRightsWatch_E.pdf">https://www.ohchr.org/sites/default/files/lib-docs/HRBodies/UPR/Documents/session13/BR/HRW_UPR_BRA_S13_2012_HumanRightsWatch_E.pdf</a> | NGO analysis addressing military impunity—useful for out-of-law context.                               |
| <b>UPR Joint NGO Statements PDF</b>         | <a href="https://uprdoc.ohchr.org/uprweb/downloadfile.aspx?file=EnglishTranslation&amp;filename=10123">https://uprdoc.ohchr.org/uprweb/downloadfile.aspx?file=EnglishTranslation&amp;filename=10123</a>                                                                             | Details implementation of UPR.                                                                         |

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|------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                                      |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                           | recommend in Brazil.                                               |
| <b>UPR Prison Torture Summary PDF</b>                | <a href="https://uprdoc.ohchr.org/uprweb/downloadfile.aspx?file=EnglishTranslation&amp;filename=3589">https://uprdoc.ohchr.org/uprweb/downloadfile.aspx?file=EnglishTranslation&amp;filename=3589</a>                                                                                                                                                                     | Summarize treatment at torture in Br detention ce                  |
| <b>OHCHR Human Rights Committee on Brazil</b>        | <a href="https://www.unognewsroom.org/story/en/1733/ohchr-human-rights-committee-press-conference-on-brazil-burundi-colombia-cyprus-lesotho-state-of-palestine-and-uganda-26-july-2023">https://www.unognewsroom.org/story/en/1733/ohchr-human-rights-committee-press-conference-on-brazil-burundi-colombia-cyprus-lesotho-state-of-palestine-and-uganda-26-july-2023</a> | Covers indigenous violence, ar accountabil concerns.               |
| <b>OHCHR UPR Submission – Data Privacy Brasil</b>    | <a href="https://www.dataprivacybr.org/en/data-privacy-brasil-participates-in-uns-ohchr-briefing-on-brazil-2/">https://www.dataprivacybr.org/en/data-privacy-brasil-participates-in-uns-ohchr-briefing-on-brazil-2/</a>                                                                                                                                                   | A key interv on AI and st data privacy under digita rights.        |
| <b>Conectas – Brazil UPR Explained</b>               | <a href="https://conectas.org/en/noticias/see-how-the-un-universal-periodic-review-works-and-its-importance-for-human-rights/">https://conectas.org/en/noticias/see-how-the-un-universal-periodic-review-works-and-its-importance-for-human-rights/</a>                                                                                                                   | Civil society primer on B role and significance UNHRC UPI cycles.  |
| <b>OHCHR UPR Summary Doc (session 13)</b>            | <a href="https://uprdoc.ohchr.org/uprweb/downloadfile.aspx?file=CoverPage&amp;filename=4017">https://uprdoc.ohchr.org/uprweb/downloadfile.aspx?file=CoverPage&amp;filename=4017</a>                                                                                                                                                                                       | Compilation UPR finding including government responses e NGO measu |
| <b>Brazil UPR Submission 2022 by Amnesty</b>         | <a href="https://uprdoc.ohchr.org/uprweb/downloadfile.aspx?file=EnglishTranslation&amp;filename=2184">https://uprdoc.ohchr.org/uprweb/downloadfile.aspx?file=EnglishTranslation&amp;filename=2184</a>                                                                                                                                                                     | Amnesty an on transitor justice from Brazil's dictatorship         |
| <b>World Report 2025 – Police Killings in Brazil</b> | <a href="https://www.ecoi.net/en/document/2120061.html">https://www.ecoi.net/en/document/2120061.html</a>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Highlights alarming sp police lethality—relevant to Item 2 dialo   |
| <b>Carnegie – Democratic Backsliding</b>             | <a href="https://carnegieendowment.org/research/2025/04/democratic-recovery-after-significant-backsliding-emergent-lessons?lang=en">https://carnegieendowment.org/research/2025/04/democratic-recovery-after-significant-backsliding-emergent-lessons?lang=en</a>                                                                                                         | Academic ir into democr pressure po Brazil.                        |
| <b>OHCHR Global 2024 Report PDF</b>                  | <a href="https://www.ohchr.org/sites/default/files/documents/publications/ohchr-reports/ohchr-report-2024.pdf">https://www.ohchr.org/sites/default/files/documents/publications/ohchr-reports/ohchr-report-2024.pdf</a>                                                                                                                                                   | Includes glc overview wi Brazil's performanc HRC-related domains.  |
| <b>OHCHR Americas NGO Statement PDF</b>              | <a href="https://www.icvanetwork.org/uploads/2024/03/NGO_Statement_Americas_SCom_March2024_WRITTEN.pdf">https://www.icvanetwork.org/uploads/2024/03/NGO_Statement_Americas_SCom_March2024_WRITTEN.pdf</a>                                                                                                                                                                 | Regional NC input coveri conflict, displaceme climate righ         |
| <b>Global R2P in the Americas (PDF)</b>              | <a href="https://www.globalr2p.org/wp-content/uploads/2024/03/2024-March-R2P-In-The-Americas-En.pdf">https://www.globalr2p.org/wp-content/uploads/2024/03/2024-March-R2P-In-The-Americas-En.pdf</a>                                                                                                                                                                       | Analyses Br response to and indigen rights—rele                    |

## Unique Aspects: Brazil at UNHRC

1. **Global Seat Despite Domestic Turmoil:** Brazil has been re-elected to the UN Human Rights Council for the 2024–26 term, and this comes with a lot of scrutiny—it's a clear indication of the country's growing diplomatic influence.
2. **Human Rights Defenders Under Siege:** The OHCHR has highlighted that economic and agribusiness interests pose a significant threat to defenders, making it even more crucial for the Human Rights Council to step up its protective measures.
3. **Spike in Police Lethal Force:** There's been a staggering 55% increase in police killings, particularly affecting Black youth, which has become a central theme in discussions about law enforcement at the HRC.
4. **Digital Privacy & AI in Education:** Brazil is one of the first countries to raise concerns about AI and student privacy with the OHCHR, taking a leading role in the realm of digital human rights.
5. **Persistent Prison Torture Reports:** Brazil is one of the first countries to raise concerns about AI and student privacy with the OHCHR, taking a leading role in the realm of digital human rights.
6. **Environmental Rights & Indigenous Protections:** UN specialized briefings and reports from the Rights Committee clearly highlight the violence in the Amazon—it's a common topic in discussions around HRC Item 2 and Item 7.
7. **UPR History Tracks Progress and Regression:** Brazil's UPR almost two decades (2008–2022) reveals shifts in compliance—used as a case study in HRC best practices.
8. **Pressure for Transitional Justice:** The Amnesty submission highlights the urgent need to address the crimes committed during the dictatorship era—an ongoing thematic concern for the Human Rights Council.
9. **Business & ESG Emphasis within Rights Framework:** Brazil's business landscape has come under the microscope from both the UN and national authorities regarding ESG and HRGs, which are essential to HRC's business objectives.
10. **Regional Responsibility Responsibility to Protect (R2P):** Brazil is actively participating in regional discussions about the Responsibility to Protect (R2P) concerning indigenous displacement, demonstrating its leadership in the conversation around preventing atrocities at the Human Rights Council.